around Moscow can strike targets beyond the atmosphere and has been tested in that mode.

Your co-orbital anti-satellite weapon is designed to destroy satellites. Furthermore, the Soviet Union began research in defenses utilizing directed energy before the United States did and seems well along in research (and incidentally, some testing outside laboratories) of lasers and other forms of directed energy. I do not point this out in reproach or suggest these activities are in violation of agreements, but if we were to follow your logic to the effect that what you call space-strike weapons would only be developed by a country planning a first strike, what would we think?

We see the Soviet Union devoting enormous resources to defensive systems, an effort which antedates by many years our own effort, and we see a Soviet Union which has built up its counterforce weapons in numbers far greater than our own. If the only reason to develop defensive weapons is to make a disarming strike possible, then clearly we should have been more concerned than we have been.

We *are* concerned, and deeply so, but not because you are developing, and, unlike us, deploying defensive weaponry, we are concerned that the Soviet Union for some reason has chosen to deploy a much larger number of weapons suitable for a disarming first strike than has the United States. There may be reasons for this other than seeking a first strike advantage, but we too must look at capabilities rather than intentions and we feel certain you have an advantage in this area.

Frankly, Mr. General Secretary, you have been misinformed if your specialists say that the missiles on our Trident submarines have a capability to destroy hardened missile silos, a capability your SS-18 definitely has. Current Trident missiles lack the